



北京邮电大学



Queen Mary
University of London

Queen Mary - BUPT
Joint Programme
and
Joint Education Institute
Teaching Assistants
(Demonstrators)
Handbook
2026-2027

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1. Joint Programme and Joint Education Institute Teaching Assistants Duties

The role of Joint Programme and Joint Education Institute (JP/JEI) Teaching Assistants (TAs) is to work closely with the JP/JEI module organisers to assist in teaching sessions (lab and tutorial) and/or participate in marking to offer a comprehensive and coherent module to all the students.

You are required to carry out the duties specified by the module organiser (or responsible lecturer) and should raise any problems relating to content, workload and scheduling etc. with the module organiser as they arise. If any of your TA duties or hours conflict with any other commitments or requirements that you have agreed to (or are bound to as part of your study, research, funding or supervision arrangements) you must raise this as early in the semester as possible. If appropriate, seek permission from your supervisor or manager before taking on JP/JEI TA duties.

If you identify any unforeseen or systematic gaps in your knowledge about the course topic you will need to discuss remedies with the module organiser; in return, the module organiser will help you tackle the issue. Do not keep the issue hidden. You should also attend planning and organisation meetings arranged by the module organiser. Likewise, you must remain in regular email contact with module organisers (or responsible lecturers) and warn them of any planned absences. Failure to do so may lead to your contract being terminated.

Depending on the module, the areas of work with which you may be involved are:

Demonstrating

Your main duty as a TA will most likely be to help and offer support to small groups of students in the labs, tutorials (or other teaching activities) by guiding them in their lab exercises or facilitating discussions in tutorials.

Marking & Assessment

You may be required to undertake some marking for lab work, coursework, class tests or other assessments set during the semester. You should discuss this in detail and agree your workload with the module organiser prior to commencing the work.

If you are required to mark assessments, you should insist on a marking scheme and make sure you understand it. Never try to muddle through – if in doubt, double check with the module organiser. The module organiser will set out a marking procedure that may involve sample marking, and you need to work according to the marking procedure.

Invigilation

You may be expected to invigilate class tests or exams during the semester. Training will be provided for this.

TA lead role

For each module, one TA will take on the role of TA lead. The TA lead is responsible for various admin work set out by the module organiser or management team, including liaising with the module organiser and other TAs on work arrangements. The TA lead should also take the responsibility of liaising with the module organiser on any issues arising from working with students.

2. TA Training

New TAs are expected to attend training sessions throughout the semester. Note: these training sessions are compulsory, and attendance will be recorded. Training times will be announced in advance; if for any reason you are not able to attend you need to contact the JP/JEI TA coordinator (Ms Gina Li) and ask for "leave of absence". Training attendance will be considered when your performance are evaluated at the end of the semester.

3. Lab Demonstration

Good Practice

Be Prepared

Ensure you are prepared adequately for the lab class. The module organiser (or responsible lecturer) will provide a lab sheet for each lab session. You should have read the lab sheet, attempted the lab work on your own beforehand (especially if you are a new TA for a module) and be aware of the type of issues that students are likely to encounter. If you are not familiar with the knowledge used in the lab, you should contact the module organiser as soon as possible for extra guidance.

For labs, the module organiser will normally provide a set of presentation slides, which TAs use to give an introduction of the lab content to students. Make sure you are familiar with the content of the presentation slides before you present to students.

Be On Time

You should arrive at the lab classroom at least 15 minutes in advance to get ready, i.e. to check classroom availability, set up computer for presentation etc. Note that turning up late to a scheduled lab session may result in “Unsatisfactory performance” (See section **10. TA Performance Evaluation**).

Be Proactive

You should be proactive in the labs. Encourage discussion and ask questions. Spend your time in the labs productively. It is NOT acceptable when you are helping in labs for you to sit and wait for students to notice you. You are required to walk around and check that students are comfortable and working on the tasks with the lab sheet provided to them and offer help without having to be asked.

Smile and be approachable as many students are more comfortable asking questions of TAs rather than the lecturer.

Be Responsive

Be supportive in your responses. All questions are valid ones, however simple or ignorant they seem.

Do not just give out answers to questions - encourage students to work out the solution for themselves and encourage them to ask questions in discussion forums outside of the lab sessions.

Ensure that you respond promptly to queries and pass on any that you cannot answer to experienced TAs or module organiser. If you do not know the answer, be honest and do not guess as the students will lose confidence in you as a TA. Depending on circumstances you may ask the module organiser after the lab or get students to post their questions in the QMplus forum.

Urgent matters

For urgent matters like power failure, equipment failure, lab room booking conflicts and other room/hardware related urgent matters, please contact Ms Fan Yue in BUPT immediately (who is in the TAs WeChat group).

4. Marking in-Lab Assessment Sessions

You may be required to do marking of the lab work within the lab sessions for some modules. Make sure you know the marking criteria and understand it correctly. You should stick to the marking criteria and mark fairly. Always read the marking criteria in advance; if you have any questions you must check with the module organiser (or responsible lecturer) as soon as possible.

Appropriate strategies should be adopted to ensure that each TA in the classroom marks a similar number of students and all marking is done within the allocated lab time, i.e. each TA marks a list of pre-allocated students, requiring students to submit on QMplus for software code, etc. The strategies should be agreed by the module organiser in advance.

5. Filling in Lab Report

Once a lab demonstration is done, one TA from each classroom of the lab session should fill in the lab report on QMplus as soon as possible.

Be accurate when you fill in the form, i.e. include the number of students attending, and any questions asked during the session. It is highly recommended that you provide comprehensive information to help the module organiser, especially on the questions students asked or any issue raised during the session.

It is advisable to take photos of the lab session to provide an overall impression of attendance and upload the photos together with the lab report.

6. Class Tests Invigilation

As a TA you may be asked to invigilate class tests during the semester. Since class tests form part of the overall assessment, proper invigilation is essential to ensure fairness and integrity.

You should receive detailed instructions and rules for the test from the module organiser in advance, e.g. whether it is an open-book or closed-book test, if a calculator is allowed, etc. If these are not provided you need to email the module organiser 3 working days before the test.

During invigilation of the class test, you should walk around the room, take attendance (if required) and keep an eye on all students. Playing on mobile phones is strictly prohibited.

If you find cases of plagiarism during the test (e.g., students copying from notes, students sharing answers with each other, students copying from other students' script), you need to stop the plagiarising students' action immediately, take the cheating materials (if any) away from the students and retain them as evidence, note down the students' names and QMUL/BUPT student numbers, and report the case to the module organiser and Ms Gina Li immediately after the test. The student(s) may complete the test once the necessary actions have been taken. You are not responsible for making decisions of academic misconduct; all you need to do is to gather evidence and report them to relevant staff so they can make appropriate decisions. You should also provide detailed information about the incident while reporting.

There are two types of class tests: paper based and QMPlus based. While the main procedures and requirements are similar, there are minor differences.

For paper-based tests, you should collect the test scripts and the hard copy of students name list in advance from Ms Gina Li. All TAs should arrive at the classroom at least 15 minutes beforehand and set the room ready for the test. The setup normally includes displaying the seating plan according to student's numbers, getting students to find their seats and sit down quickly, announcing the test rules and duration. You may receive additional instructions regarding the setup, which you are expected to follow.

After the test has finished and all scripts have been collected, you need to count the total number of scripts to ensure it matches the number of students who attended. Any unused scripts must be collected and put in the envelopes together with the used ones.

For QMplus based tests, you will normally receive instructions and name list from lecturers. For the test you need to arrive at the lab at least 15 minutes beforehand. If the test is in a lab room, you need to ensure the lab computers are switched on. You should also be prepared to deal with various emergencies, e.g. unusable lab computer, student forgetting QMplus password etc. When students complete the test, you should ensure each of them has signed the student name list and logged out on the QMPlus page before leaving the lab.

7. Marking

For coursework or class test scripts marking, you should always follow the marking guidelines provided by the module organiser. The module organiser may adopt a marking procedure involving sampling and second marking, and you need to follow instructions from the module organiser. Any questions regarding the marking procedure or marking scheme should be directed to the module organiser as soon as possible.

If you mark scripts or coursework on paper, make sure that the scripts and coursework are handled securely. Marking should be done in a secure environment (e.g., an office). Marking in public places (e.g., a coffee shop) is prohibited. All scripts should be stored in a secure location during marking, until they are returned to Ms. Gina Li for archiving.

You cannot discuss with students about marking or the marks. Furthermore, marking must NOT be influenced in any way by personal relations with students.

Ideally, you should not be a TA on a module where a family member is a student. All such instances (including close relationships with any student or staff member) must be declared to Ms Gina Li and the module organiser, as they may create a conflict of interest.

If any student has queries about the marks or would like to have the marks reviewed, please refer the student to the "Coursework Mark Review Request" section on QMplus for relevant modules.

8. Communicating with the Module Organiser and Lecturers

It is very important that you communicate with the module organiser or responsible lecturers in a timely manner, especially when teaching staff are not on site during labs/class tests. Questions and issues arising should be reported to relevant teaching staff as soon as possible, so decisions can be made to avoid further problems, as well as to improve students learning experience.

It is advisable that you agree with the module organiser at the start of the semester the preferred forms of communication, e.g. emails, WeChat, or other means.

Do not only reply on the lead TA to communicate with the module organiser; you may come across matters or problems individually so it is best that you communicate individually with the relevant teaching staff.

9. Absence

Planned Absence

Arrangements for the labs are normally made at the beginning of the semester. Similarly test invigilation times are normally announced in advance. If you know you are going to be away (e.g., for a conference) for a certain period of time, you should avoid arranging work for those times. If you need to miss an arranged session, it is your duty to ensure that you have found someone suitable to cover your sessions. You should talk to the module organiser and Ms Gina Li to let them know what you have arranged and be sure that they are happy with your replacement; ideally this should be done one week prior to the lab session and certainly no later than 3 working days beforehand.

Last Minute Changes

Last minute changes on lab demonstration arrangements or invigilation (i.e., changes made within **3 working days** prior to the session) should be avoided as much as possible. If you are unable to attend a scheduled lab or invigilation session due to unforeseen circumstances (e.g., your supervisor asks you to go on a business trip at short notice), you need to inform the module organiser, Ms Gina Li and TA lead as soon as possible, and provide supporting evidence for your claimed reason. You should also arrange for a replacement to cover your session. Any TA failing to attend without prior arrangement will be recorded as having an unexcused absence and poor performance.

10. TA performance evaluation

TAs will be expected to accept their duties as stipulated by the module organiser (and management staff), and to confirm they understand them and the JP/JEI's expectations of them. TAs' performance is subject to the evaluation of the module organiser, responsible lecturer, QM Administrators and the TA Performance Evaluation Committee.

As part of the evaluation process, QM teaching staff and management staff will be checking labs and/or class test invigilation randomly. Poor performance will be recorded and accumulation of poor records will lead to the final evaluation being "Needs Improvement" or "Unsatisfactory".

Poor performance includes (but is not limited to):

- arriving late to lab demonstration or invigilation (i.e., less than 15 minutes before the session start time),
- making last minute changes (i.e., within 3 working days prior to the session) without valid reason and/or evidence,
- sitting down during lab demonstration or invigilation sessions,
- playing on mobile phones during lab demonstration or invigilation sessions,
- mishandling test scripts (e.g., losing scripts),
- marking without following the set marking scheme,
- failing to attend TA training sessions and/or meetings without valid reasons,
- claiming work hours without doing the work, or claiming more work hours than actually worked,
- asking someone else to cover lab or training sessions on your behalf, under false representation.

11. Payment

Payment for Work

1. Coursework marking: 80 RMB/hour.
Coursework marking hours must be estimated and agreed by the module organiser; TAs may not specify arbitrary hours for marking. Please confirm with the module organiser the marking hours before a claim form is submitted.
2. Demonstration: 100 RMB/hour.
This includes lab demonstration and lab assessment.
3. Final year project work: 80 RMB/hour.
4. Other work: 50 RMB/hour.
Other work includes lab preparation and other specific work assigned and approved by the MO in advance only. The number of hours allocated for such work will be determined by the MO, normally at the beginning of the semester.
5. TA lead bonus.
The TA Lead will receive a fixed bonus amount, depending on the number of TAs and the additional workload associated with the module.
6. Invigilation: 100 RMB/hour.
Payment is calculated based on scheduled hours without extra hours. For final exam invigilation, a bonus will be paid based on the number of exams invigilated.
7. New TAs who attend all required training sessions in person will be eligible for the bonus. Experienced TAs who fail the assessment and are required to re-attend training will not be eligible for the bonus in this case.

Note:

TAs must use the BUPT shuttle bus when travelling between the Main Campus and Shahe Campus for cross-campus TA work. For each round trip between the two campuses, TAs may claim **an additional two hours** at the other work rate, regardless of the number of sessions or duties undertaken during that visit. QM will not accept claim requests for taxi fares or any other expenses incurred from personal arrangements.

Performance-Based Payment

The performance of TAs will be observed and recorded by module organisers, lecturers and management staff as part of daily operations.

At the end of the semester, the TA Performance Evaluation Committee will assess each TA's overall performance (for more details please see section **10. TA Performance Evaluation**) and assign one of the four categories: Excellent, Satisfactory, Needs improvement or Unsatisfactory.

- **Excellent:** TAs who demonstrate responsibility, proactivity, effective communication and consistently delivery work to a high standard. Excellent TAs will receive an additional 10% payment on the relevant module payment. This payment will be finalised at the end of the semester.

- **Satisfactory:** TAs who meet expected standards will get 100% of the payment.
- **Needs Improvement:** TAs in this category may show lapses in punctuality, incomplete task execution, inadequate communication, or inconsistent adherence to module requirements. They are expected to improve performance, and their final payment may be reduced to **70% to 95%** of the overall payment, as determined by the TA Performance Evaluation Committee.
- **Unsatisfactory:** TAs in this category consistently fail to meet expectations, demonstrating significant deficiencies in responsibility, task completion, or professional conduct. Final payment may be reduced to **50%-80%** of the overall payment, and an “Unsatisfactory” evaluation may result in ineligibility for future recruitment.

In addition to the end-of-semester evaluation, the TA Performance Evaluation Committee reserves the right to review and act on urgent cases as needed.

Contacts

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Mr Song (Main campus)	Mobile: 18911815850		BUPT (lab facility)
Mr Shi (Shahe campus)	Mobile: 13661052212		BUPT (lab facility)

All the staff listed are in the TAs' WeChat group, except for the lab staff.